

Overview

This project will develop robust polymerase chain reaction (PCR) methods to detect *Theileria equi* and *Babesia Caballi*, the pathogens that cause equine piroplasmosis (EP). These tests will complement serological tests for EP at the Australian Centre for Disease Preparedness (ACDP).

The project will strengthen Australia's diagnostic capacity for EP. It will support testing needed for trade-related certification in the equine industry. By establishing local, National Association of Testing Authorities (NATA) accredited testing capability, the project will deliver faster, more reliable diagnosis and reduce reliance on overseas laboratories. This will give greater confidence in Australia's equine health standards.

Project Lead: Australian Centre for Disease Preparedness; Department of Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry

Project Contact: animalhealthlaboratories@aff.gov.au

Project Status: Active

Project Dates: due for completion May 2026

Objective alignment:

- 2 - Improve Australia's preparedness and ability to respond to emergency animal diseases

Activity alignment:

- 2.1 – Implement actions under National Animal Health Surveillance Business Plan and National Animal Health Diagnostic Business Plan.

See more

See previous updates and future actions on the [National Animal Health Diagnostic Business Plan](#).

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/agriculture-land/animal/health/animal-plan/project-71>